

Fight Club: The electoral competition on the Spanish Radical Right-Wing

El Club de la Lucha: La competición electoral de la Derecha Radical española

IMANOL NEGRAL

Euskal Herriko Unibertsitatea/Universidad del País Vasco

ÁLVARO SÁNCHEZ-GARCÍA

Centro de Estudios Políticos y Constitucionales

Universidad de Salamanca

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Abstract

The rise of VOX in 2018 put an end to Spanish exceptionalism in the absence of a genuine radical right-wing party. However, the emergence of Se Acabó la Fiesta (SALF) in 2024 consolidated an unprecedented scenario: the coexistence of two national players competing for a similar electorate. Although both are ideologically close, this work shows that they mobilise different voter profiles. Through an empirical analysis based on an extensive battery of surveys from the Sociological Research Centre (CIS), this study examines the factors that explain the distribution of electoral support between VOX and SALF. The results indicate that nativism—an attitude commonly tied to the radical right—does not play a decisive role in the competition between VOX and SALF. Nevertheless, authoritarianism is positively associated with support for VOX. In contrast, anti-partitocracy attitudes and the use of social media as a channel of information are the main predictors of voting for SALF. This research contributes to the literature on the fragmentation of the radical right in Europe. It also offers keys to understanding the competition in this space in Spain, showing that SALF attracts an electorate far removed from classic ideological frameworks of the radical right, despite its discursive alignment with that family of parties.

Keywords: Radical right-wing, electoral behaviour, partitocracy, social media, and Spain.

Resumen

El ascenso de VOX en 2018 puso fin al excepcionalismo español ante la ausencia de un auténtico partido de derecha radical. Sin embargo, la aparición de Se Acabó la Fiesta (SALF) en 2024 consolidó un escenario sin precedentes: la coexistencia de dos actores nacionales que compiten por un electorado similar. Si bien ambos son ideológicamente cercanos, este trabajo muestra que movilizan diferentes perfiles de votantes. Mediante un análisis empírico basado en una extensa batería de encuestas del Centro de Investigaciones Sociológicas (CIS), este estudio examina los factores que explican la distribución del apoyo electoral entre VOX y SALF. Los resultados indican que el nativismo —una actitud comúnmente vinculada a la derecha radical— no desempeña un papel decisivo en la competencia entre VOX y SALF. Sin embargo, el autoritarismo se asocia positivamente con el apoyo a VOX. Por el contrario, las actitudes anti-partitocracia y el uso de las redes sociales como canal de información son los principales predictores del voto a SALF. Esta investigación contribuye a la literatura sobre la fragmentación de la derecha radical en Europa. También ofrece claves para comprender la competencia en este espacio en España, mostrando que SALF atrae a un electorado alejado de los marcos ideológicos clásicos de la derecha radical, a pesar de su alineamiento discursivo con esa familia de partidos.

Palabras clave: Derecha radical, comportamiento electoral, partitocracia, redes sociales y España.

1. INTRODUCTION

On June 9, 2024, the landscape of the Spanish radical right —until then dominated by VOX— was disrupted by the unexpected emergence of a new actor: Se Acabó la Fiesta (SALF, *The Party Is Over*). In the European Parliament (EP) elections held that day, the candidacy led by Alvisé Pérez, a radical-right activist and influencer, achieved a surprising breakthrough¹. In just a few months, Alvisé moved from the realm of social media to the political arena, securing 800,763 votes (4.5%) —more than several established parties, including Podemos (*We Can*)— and winning half as many votes as VOX (1,688,255), its main competitor on the radical right, thereby opening an unprecedented electoral competition within that space.

In recent years, several Western democracies have witnessed the simultaneous presence of multiple radical right parties (RRP), often competing for similar

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1. EP elections have long been regarded as favourable arenas for the institutionalisation of new political actors. On the supply side, their single national district and lower effective entry barriers reduce the disadvantages faced by territorially dispersed and smaller parties (Lago and Martínez, 2011). On the demand side, their second-order character weakens partisan attachments and strategic voting, encouraging voters to support alternative or protest options (Reif and Schmitt, 1980; Hobolt and de Vries, 2016). Taken together, these features make EP elections particularly conducive to the electoral breakthrough of emerging parties, such as Podemos (Riera and Russo, 2016).

electorates. Such dynamics have emerged in countries like Italy, Belgium, the Netherlands, Greece, and Spain. While Spain has traditionally shown limited intra-family competition, since 2024 it has featured two such competitors. On the one hand, Aliança Catalana (AC, *Catalan Alliance*) has emerged to compete with VOX in the radical right space, though in this case the division is clearly shaped by nationalism: VOX defends Spanish nationalism, whereas AC adopts a Catalan nationalist stance (Martínez-Cantó and Tudó-Cisquella, 2025). On the other hand, there is the competition between VOX and SALF, which, unlike AC, compete across the entire national territory. Against this backdrop, the aim of this paper is to explain how voters choose between ideologically proximate radical right parties under conditions of intra-family competition. We address this question by focusing on the Spanish case, where competition between an established party (VOX) and a challenger actor (SALF) provides a useful setting to study how voters differentiate between competing radical right actors. In this sense, the “Fight Club” dynamic between VOX and SALF reflects broader comparative patterns of intra-radical right rivalry and highlights the importance of understanding how voters differentiate between ideologically proximate actors.

This article addresses this growing competition between RRP, focusing on the Spanish case. From a political demand perspective, we examine a set of factors that structure voters’ choice between these two actors. Specifically, we analyse four key dimensions that help explain this competition. Two relate to core ideological tenets of the radical right, while the remaining two capture more actor-specific features linked to political style, communication, and leadership profile.

Our findings indicate that three of these dimensions significantly structure vote choice between the two parties. Anti-party sentiment and reliance on social media increase support for SALF relative to VOX, whereas authoritarian attitudes are positively associated with support for VOX. By contrast, nativist orientations do not significantly differentiate between their electorates.

This work advances the literature on RRP by examining electoral competition within the radical right family rather than the success of a single party. In contrast to existing studies focused on countries such as Italy, Belgium, or Greece, we explore this phenomenon in the Spanish context—a case that has long been considered an outlier in the rise of the radical right (Alonso and Rovira, 2015). Analysing the interactivity between an incumbent and a challenger actor allows us to reassess assumptions about how RRP emerge, differentiate themselves, and compete for support. Moreover, this is one of the first papers to analyse the vote for SALF (alongside recent work by Padilla Moreno-Torres et al., 2025).

The article is organised as follows. The next section outlines the analytical framework for comparing both parties and examining their competition, as well as the working hypotheses. Next, the data and methodological strategy are introduced, followed by the contextualisation of the case study. Subsequently, the empirical analysis and its discussion is presented. Finally, the article summarises the main findings and proposes future lines of research on competition between RRP.

2. INTRA-FAMILY COMPETITION IN THE RADICAL RIGHT

In recent decades, political science has closely followed the rise of RRP^s across Western democracies on both sides of the Atlantic². These parties have gradually expanded their presence in national parliaments and, in some cases, have captured significant political power (Mudde, 2019). While their emergence was relatively swift in many countries, others —such as Spain, Portugal, and Ireland— witnessed a delayed advance or, in the case of Ireland, none at all (Heyne and Manucci, 2021; Alonso and Rovira, 2015). However, the current landscape suggests a shift: the key question is no longer whether RRP^s exist, but rather how many operate within each political system. According to the 2024 wave of the Chapel Hill Expert Survey (CHES), there were 48 RRP^s across the 31 countries included in the sample. Bulgaria tops the list with five such parties, followed by Denmark, Greece, Hungary, and Romania, each with three. Eight other countries host two RRP^s, while fifteen have a single one. Only three countries —Ireland, Malta, and Iceland— remain immune to their presence (Rovny et al., 2025). Against this backdrop, an important question emerges: in countries where multiple RRP^s coexist, what have been the main axes of competition between them?

Rivalry among RRP^s has received relatively little attention in the literature (see Martínez-Cantó and Tudó-Cisquella (2025), De Lange (2022), or Basile and Borri (2022) as notable exceptions). However, given the current landscape in which these parties operate, we propose two main mechanisms, each of which addresses different dimensions that may influence voters' choice between competing RRP^s.

Firstly, vote choice between two (or more) RRP^s may be structured by ideological differences between them. Even within the same party family, these organisations may differ in the narratives they adopt or the emphasis they place on specific issues. One of the most paradigmatic examples is Greece, where the contrast between Elliniki Lysi (EL, *Greek Solution*) and the Spartiátes (*Spartans*) lies in the latter's more extremist positions. In fact, some investigations have pointed to the Spartiátes' alleged links with the previously outlawed Chrysí Avgí (XA, *Golden Dawn*) (Mylonas, 2024). In the Netherlands, the competition between Partij voor de Vrijheid (PVV, *Party for Freedom*) and Forum voor Democratie (PvD, *Forum for Democracy*) also illustrates ideological differentiation —albeit more subtly— along economic lines, with the former adopting a more centralist and chauvinistic stance (De Lange, 2022; Abts et al., 2021). In other cases, such as France, the distinctions are even less pronounced. Nonetheless, recent research has highlighted that Reconquête (REC, *Reconquest*) places stronger discursive emphasis on traditional masculinity than the Rassemblement National (RN, *National Rally*) (Mayer, 2022). In short, existing comparative research shows that variation in issue emphasis, narrative framing, and symbolic

2. In some cases, such as the United States or Germany, competition among radical right-wing populist forces takes place within the parties themselves (Aiolfi, 2024).

positioning, whether on welfare, traditional values, or specific concepts such as sovereignty (Basile and Borri, 2022), can systematically shape why voters select one RRP over another.

Additionally, other scholars emphasise that differing conceptions of territorial identity may constitute another relevant cleavage. Italy offers a particularly illustrative example: here, the rivalry between Lega (*League*) and Fratelli d'Italia (FdI, *Brothers of Italy*) is still shaped, to some extent, by the Lega's regionalist origins in Northern Italy, despite the party's national rebranding (Basile and Borri, 2022). Similar patterns can be found in other subnational contexts, such as Catalonia (Spain), where VOX competes with AC, or in Flanders (Belgium), where Vlaams Belang (VB, *Flemish Interest*) and the Nieuw-Vlaamse Alliantie (N-VA, *New Flemish Alliance*) vie for voters' support (Camatarri et al., 2025). However, in the Flemish case, the classification of N-VA as part of the radical right is more contested (Rooduijn et al., 2023). In all these cases, the radical right's political offer is shaped—at least in part—by competing visions of the territorial organisation of the state.

Regarding the ideological core of this first mechanism, we focus on two key dimensions. First, as proposed by Mudde (2007), anti-immigration orientation is the main feature of the radical right. Immigration is considered the major threat to the homogeneity of the nation. In this vein, the concept of nativism has recently emerged in social science, bringing together national and anti-immigration orientations and attitudes. Nativism is therefore conceived as an ideology that postulates “that states should be inhabited exclusively by members of the native group ('the nation') and that non-native elements (persons and ideas) are fundamentally threatening to the homogenous nation-state” (Mudde, 2007: 22).

Second, hand in hand with the political issue of immigration, we can also identify authoritarianism as a secondary element at the ideological core of the radical right (Mudde, 2007). Authoritarianism emerges as a disposition towards an ordered and hierarchical society in which infractions are severely punished (Lubbers and Coenders, 2017). Authoritarian attitudes have also been identified as a potential factor explaining differences in support among radical right actors (Puleo et al., 2024). Following the classical understanding developed by the Frankfurt School (Adorno et al., 1950), we conceptualise authoritarianism as support for law and order and for the punishment of those perceived as part of the outgroup.

These attitudes should be more strongly associated with support for RRP that emphasise such themes more prominently in their political messaging. Importantly, research on party competition shows that when ideologically similar parties compete, voters tend to choose between them based on differences in issue emphasis and rhetorical intensity rather than on their overall ideological placement (Meguid, 2005) or their government/opposition status (Akkerman and De Lange, 2012). Challenger and populist parties may also have stronger incentives to highlight these issues more visibly to voters (Kollberg, 2025). This logic is particularly relevant in contexts of intra-family competition. Accordingly, we expect that:

Hypothesis 1: *Nativist attitudes are associated with a greater likelihood of voting for RRP that emphasise nativist rhetoric, particularly when challenger actors signal such appeals more intensively than their competitors.*

H2: *Higher levels of authoritarian attitudes are associated with a greater likelihood of voting for RRP that emphasise authoritarian themes, especially when these cues are more strongly articulated by challenger parties.*

Furthermore, beyond ideological differences, variation in discursive and organisational strategies may be decisive. A first distinction concerns whether a RRP is an incumbent or a challenger actor. Some authors argue that access to power may contribute to the normalisation of such parties (Field and Alonso, 2024), leading them to be perceived as more mainstream or institutionalised actors. Conversely, emerging actors that have not yet attained power may be classified as challenger parties and, in many cases, as anti-political actors. This distinction may have systematic consequences for patterns of electoral support. Recent research further suggests that challenger parties possess stronger vote-seeking incentives than mainstream actors, which encourages them to adopt more electorally responsive communication strategies. In particular, challenger politicians are more likely to employ anti-establishment rhetoric and engage in issue entrepreneurship when such signals are expected to reach voters and generate electoral returns (Kollberg, 2025). RRP may also differ in their adoption of populist narratives (Rooduijn et al., 2023). Existing research suggests that variation in populist rhetoric may influence vote choice (Basile and Borri, 2022). More broadly, comparative evidence indicates that strategic positioning within competitive multi-party environments can actively drive divergence between ideologically proximate RRP. For instance, De Lange (2022) shows that competing RRP in the Netherlands adopted increasingly differentiated opposition strategies during the COVID-19 pandemic (shifting from a shared anti-government stance to distinct and even conflicting positions) in order to carve out separate electoral niches. This suggests that intra-family competition may incentivise strategic differentiation in rhetoric, issue framing, and oppositional style, which in turn can shape voters' choices between otherwise similar parties.

Therefore, thirdly, anti-partitocracy attitudes may constitute a distinct form of oppositional politics. Within this broader category, the literature distinguishes between anti-establishment appeals (Barr, 2009; Mudde, 2007; Schedler, 1996) and more radical forms of anti-politics or anti-system positions (Keren, 2000). Our focus is on the latter, as anti-political and anti-system sentiments are more often championed by political outsiders who reject not only the governing elites but the legitimacy of the political system itself (Barr, 2009). In contrast to anti-establishment views—which criticise those in power while accepting the broader rules of the game and are frequently associated with populist radical right-wing and other challenger parties (De Vries and Hobolt, 2020; Mudde, 2007)—anti-politics critiques target the structure of representative democracy, claiming that the entire party system is fundamentally flawed (Barr, 2009: 32). Anti-partitocracy aligns with this more radical stance by identifying political parties as the main source of systemic dysfunction.

From this perspective, challenger parties may constitute particularly attractive options for voters dissatisfied with representative institutions. This is especially likely when such actors adopt explicitly anti-political narratives. Thus, we expect that:

***H3:** Higher levels of anti-partitocracy attitudes are associated with a greater likelihood of voting for challenger RRP, particularly those adopting anti-political narratives.*

Fourthly, social media exposure is strongly linked to support for radical right (Krämer, 2017). Recent studies suggest that Alternative für Deutschland (AfD, Alternative for Germany) voters, for example, tend to favour alternative online media over public broadcasting (Stier et al., 2025). Technological advancements and the rise of social networks have profoundly reshaped traditional information consumption habits (Newman et al., 2024). This shift has been particularly pronounced in contexts of political disaffection, where distrust in mainstream media and elites drives audiences toward narratives that challenge the status quo. RRP have effectively leveraged social media to amplify their political messages, making their issues more prominent and even reaching audiences beyond their traditional support base (Schumann et al., 2021).

From a strategic perspective, social media use should benefit challenger RRP more strongly. While institutionalised RRP tend to receive greater coverage in traditional media environments, challenger actors may rely more heavily on digital platforms for message dissemination. Thus, we expect that:

***H4:** Higher levels of information through social media are associated with a greater likelihood of voting for challenger RRP.*

Taken together, these mechanisms suggest that competition between ideologically proximate RRP should depend on how voters respond to ideological cues, anti-system orientations, and communication strategies. This theoretical framework is particularly suited to analysing competitions between an institutionalised radical right incumbent and a challenger outsider, a configuration that the empirical case examined here exemplifies. Building on this literature, the next subsection derives testable hypotheses about how these mechanisms shape voters' choice between competing RRP.

3. DATA AND METHODS

The general premise of this study is to explore the electoral competitiveness of the radical right in Spain, analysing the voting determinants that tip the balance between VOX and SALF. The Spanish case offers fertile ground for study. The recent surge of SALF (and AC in the Catalan region) and the consolidation of VOX make Spain a suitable arena for analysing not only the processes of emergence, but also those of

competition and differentiation in contexts previously considered resistant to their electoral development.

The study focuses on this research strategy for several reasons. First, both parties operate at the national level, articulate partially convergent narratives, and compete for a potentially overlapping electorate within the radical right, which is appropriate for analysing intra-bloc competition. Secondly, their coexistence in the same pre- and post-electoral scenario —the European elections— offers a valuable empirical opportunity: it allows us to observe voting decisions between ideologically close alternatives within the same context, thus reinforcing the internal validity of the analysis compared to temporal or transnational comparisons. Finally, the analysis of rivalry among RRP's allows for addressing an issue that has received little attention in the literature. Although Section 4 considers elements of internal differentiation such as discursive strategies or thematic priorities, the main emphasis of this study is on the political demand side, focusing on the attitudinal orientations and socio-demographic profiles of voters that condition the choice between closely aligned parties within the same political space.

To analyse the phenomenon under study and to test our hypotheses, we used CIS data. However, we cannot do this with a single survey, as not all of them simultaneously include the variables needed to operationalise our assumptions and ensure sufficient observations for the parties under comparison. Therefore, we constructed a grouped dataset —in line with other research (e.g., Padilla Moreno-Torres et al., 2025; Yildirim and Solvig, 2025)— including all 2024 surveys that report voting intentions for SALF (and VOX), that is, those published between May and December.

Nevertheless, as shown in Table 1, only four surveys are used in the main empirical analyses according to each hypothesis (see the last column). This selection follows a logic based on criteria of analytical relevance, similar to the concept of 'selection of influential cases' proposed by Seawright and Gerring (2008), according to which cases are chosen for their ability to facilitate the testing of hypotheses, that is, for the availability of key variables and sufficient observations.

TABLE 1.

CIS SURVEYS USED TO TEST THE HYPOTHESES, AND VOX AND SALF SAMPLES.

Study	Completion date (in 2024)	N	VOX N (%)	SALF N (%)	Hypotheses
Special: EU Election Campaign	May 23-30	7,491	516 (6.89)	317 (4.23)	H4
EU Post-electoral	Jun 17-21	3,010	234 (7.77)	119 (3.95)	H4
Special: <i>Latinobarómetro</i> XVI	Sep 6-11	2,543	169 (6.65)	66 (2.60)	H1 and H3
Special: Polarisation and Ideology	Oct 11-21	3,928	276 (7.03)	91 (2.32)	H2

In this sense, it should be noted that data pooling is a well-established methodological strategy that allows comparable cross-sectional studies to be combined into a

single analytical file, increasing the sample size and variability available for hypothesis testing. In the analysis of successive surveys, this technique facilitates more robust estimates and the exploration of political dynamics at different points in time (Johnston and Brady, 2002). Its advantages include increased statistical power to analyse specific subgroups with greater precision, and the possibility of examining multiple theoretical expectations that could not be tested with a single survey. However, this strategy also requires ensuring comparability between surveys, as variations in the wording of questions, sample design, or political context can affect the equivalence of measurements. Likewise, temporal heterogeneity must also be controlled—through fixed effects—in order to avoid bias in the estimates.

Regarding the variables used in this article, and in accordance with its purpose, we adopt as the dependent variable the dichotomous vote intention between VOX (0) and SALF (1)³ (see Figure B.3 in the Appendix B, which shows the voting intention trends for both parties).

In order to verify our four expectations, we use the following variables:

- **Nativism.** Understanding nativism in a broad and multidimensional sense, we use four statements to capture attitudes towards immigration, as it constitutes the core of nativism: “Immigrants are good for the country’s economy”, “Immigrants come to compete for our jobs”, “Immigrants cause an increase in crime”, and “Immigrants improve our society with ideas and culture”. Respondents could choose from four possible answers: (1) Strongly agree, (2) Agree, (3) Disagree, and (4) Strongly disagree. Based on the wording of each statement, we recoded the responses on a 1-to-4 scale, ensuring that higher values consistently reflect stronger opposition to immigration. The final nativism variable is constructed as the arithmetic mean of the responses across these four items.
- **Authoritarianism.** We tested this hypothesis using respondents’ level of agreement with the following statements: “The state must guarantee security and order, even if this means limiting rights or freedoms” and “I would not mind living in an undemocratic country if it guarantees me a better quality of life”. We recoded the original responses — (1) Strongly disagree, (2) Disagree, (3) Neither agree nor disagree, (4) Agree and (5) Strongly agree— into a categorical indicator of level of agreement. Finally, we operationalised authoritarianism as the arithmetic mean of the agreement levels with both statements, ranging from 0 (minimum agreement) to 5 (maximum agreement).
- **Anti-partitocracy.** To operationalise this concept, we rely on the question: “Which of the following phrases is closest to your way of thinking?”, the answers being “Without political parties there can be no democracy”; and “Democracy can function without parties”. Thus, we keep the dichotomous

3. The post-election survey does not incorporate the voting intention question, instead, we use the vote recall in the EP elections of 9 June 2024.

coding and consider those who answered the first option (0) ‘Disagree’ —i.e. pro-partitocracy, and (1) ‘Agree’— i.e. anti-partitocracy⁴.

- **Information through social networks.** We rely on a question from the pre-election survey that asks: “Through which media did you primarily inform yourself about the campaign for the European Parliament elections on 9 June?” From the various response options, we create a binary variable distinguishing between (0) ‘Other sources’ and (1) ‘Social media’⁵. For a more detailed analysis of the specific social networks used by VOX and SALF, see Figure B.7.

3.1. *Empirical strategy*

To examine our hypotheses, we estimate logit models —one per expectation— resulting in a total of four models (see Table B.1 in the Appendix B). Given that the dependent variable captures a dichotomous choice between VOX and SALF, logistic regression is an appropriate empirical strategy, as it models the probability of choosing one alternative over another without assuming linearity in the relationship between predictors and outcome (Norton and Dowd, 2018). The results are reported in terms of log-odds coefficients, which permit a direct assessment of the direction and magnitude of the estimated effects (Mood, 2010). Positive coefficients indicate a higher likelihood of choosing SALF over the reference category (VOX), whereas negative coefficients indicate the opposite⁶. Moreover, it should be noted that each model includes a set of common control variables: gender (reference category: female), age, urban habitat (rural areas), paid work (not working), high net income (low: $\leq 1,800$ euros) and ideological self-placement on the left-right scale.⁷ For more details on the descriptive statistics of all variables included in our analysis, see Tables A.2 and A.3 in the Appendix A.

This strategy is appropriate for our purposes. Logit modelling is ideal for analysing competition between ideologically similar parties, as it isolates the determinants of choice within a shared electoral space rather than at the level of the entire party system. Secondly, separate estimation by expectations facilitates a parsimonious and theoretically guided assessment of each explanatory dimension, maintaining comparability

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4. It would have been analytically relevant to include an additional institutional variable —for instance, attitudes toward the Crown— as a potential axis of differentiation between VOX and SALF. However, the absence of such items in the CIS surveys prevents examination of this dimension and limits the analysis’s ability to capture this possible fracture.
 5. ‘Other sources’ includes ‘Press, in print format’, ‘Press, in digital format’, ‘Television’, ‘Radio’, ‘Personal contacts, meetings, rallies, etc.’, ‘Other media’, ‘Not informed, not interested in politics’, and ‘No other media’.
 6. In the case of continuous variables, the sign of the coefficient reflects the direction of the relationship across the range of the variable.
 7. In the ‘Special: *Latinobarómetro* XVI’ survey, the scale is measured from 0 to 10, while in the rest of the surveys the range is from 1 to 10.

between models. Third, the logit model provides consistent and easily interpretable estimates in probabilistic terms when the dependent variable is binary. However, this strategy also has limitations. By restricting the analysis to a dichotomous comparison, it does not capture the full structure of party competition. Moreover, the pooled dataset combines multiple surveys without respondent overlap across them. We proceed to address this by estimating logit models with fixed effects per survey to account for possible variations in the context of the surveys and in the wording of the questions. Likewise, and in line with the latter, as in any observational analysis based on cross-sectional survey data, the results should be interpreted in terms of statistical associations rather than strict causality, as they may be affected by constraints in the measurement of certain constructs. Nevertheless, the approach adopted is consistent with the objective of the study.

Besides, we include two additional regression models as a robustness test to complete the analysis. Using the same independent variables, we first estimate a model in which the dependent variable distinguishes between voting for SALF (1) and for all other political parties (0). The results of this model can be found in Table B.2 of Appendix B. Next, we applied a multinomial logistic regression model⁸ with the vote for the Partido Popular (PP, *Popular Party*) as the reference category (1), compared to the vote for VOX (2) and SALF (3). The results of these models can be found in Table B.3 of Appendix B.

4. VOX AND SALF IN SPANISH POLITICS

Turning to the Spanish case, we argue that competition between VOX and SALF is driven primarily by differences in political style and strategic positioning, rather than by deep ideological or territorial cleavages, although it has clearly been catalysed by Alvisé's personal political ambitions. Although the two actors share much of their political core (and indeed, Alvisé previously collaborated with VOX⁹ through his media channels) they diverge in tone, repertoire, and self-presentation, including the intensity and framing of anti-immigration rhetoric, the emphasis placed on punitive "law-and-order" appeals, and the extent of anti-partitocratic mobilisation. These supply-side differences provide the contextual backdrop for the demand-side mechanisms theorised in Section 2.

8. This technique is appropriate when the dependent variable has more than two nominal categories (Long, 2014). It allows us to simultaneously estimate the probability of choosing between different options, taking one as a reference and comparing the determinants of the vote between them. Its main advantage is that it allows capturing the structure of electoral competition between multiple alternatives or, as in this case, between a specific set of predetermined options.

9. He has also worked for other centre-right parties such as Unión Progreso y Democracia (UPyD, *Union, Progress and Democracy*) and Ciudadanos (Cs, *Citizens*).

More broadly, SALF shares strategic traits with other contemporary radical right challengers. Like Velopoulos (the leader of EL) in Greece, Alvisé comes from the media world and has used this platform to launch his political career. Similarly, SALF, much like REC in France (Aiolfi, 2024), adopts a more confrontational and outsider tone than more institutionalised competitors (VOX and RN, respectively). In this sense, the VOX-SALF contest illustrates a broader pattern of intra-family competition between an institutionalised incumbent and a personalistic outsider challenger. The following section provides the minimum contextual information needed for an international reader to understand both actors and the parameters of their competition before turning to the empirical results.

4.1. *VOX and SALF: evolution and ideological features*

On the one side of this electoral competition is VOX, the first RRP. It was founded in December 2013 as a split from the PP. After several failed elections, VOX first entered institutional politics in the 2018 Andalusian regional elections, and a year later gained seats in the Spanish Parliament (Turnbull-Dugarte, 2019), consolidating its position in 2023 as the country's third political force (Vall-Prat and Rodon, 2024). The party has been the subject of extensive scholarly work, examining its electorate both at the individual (Turnbull-Dugarte et al., 2020) and aggregate level (Sánchez-García and Negral, 2023).

Notably, some researchers have questioned its political credentials. First, some have labelled it as far right, while the vast majority have leaned towards the radical right. Some, such as Ortiz Barquero and Ramos-González (2021), based on Mudde's definition, understand that VOX meets the criteria of being nominally democratic (although it opposes some principles of liberal democracy). In contrast, the far right is eminently anti-democratic and opposes popular sovereignty (Mudde, 2007: 31). Second, VOX is widely considered a RRP, while some authors consider populism to be secondary (Marcos-Marne et al., 2021; Ortiz Barquero and Ramos-González, 2021), the populist label is more readily applied by much of the academic literature (e.g. Galais and Pérez-Rajó, 2023; Heyne and Manucci, 2021), as well as by two of the most important expert databases, namely CHES (Rovny et al., 2025) and the Popu-List (Rooduijn et al., 2023). For this reason, we consider VOX to be a populist RRP.

Furthermore, VOX is instead emphasising its clearly nativist and nationalist dimensions (Marcos-Marne et al., 2021; Ortiz Barquero and Ramos-González, 2021; Ungureanu and Sanjaume-Calvet, 2024), alongside a strong anti-feminist discourse (Anduiza and Rico, 2022). It has also served as a vehicle for anti-immigration discontent (Iglesias-Pascual et al., 2021) and it is characterised by a remarkable neoliberal economic profile (Sánchez-García and Marcos-Marne, 2026).

Despite its radical positioning, VOX has progressively integrated into the Spanish party system, adopting more conventional and institutionalised practices. In recent years, it has formed alliances with the mainstream conservative party (PP) at both

regional and local levels (Field and Alonso, 2024). For this reason, in addition to the first RRP and its populist narrative, which is more important for this article, we can consider that VOX has become the mainstream representative of the radical right.

On the other side is SALF, a political actor that emerged in early 2024, when its leader, Alvisé —a well-known activist and influencer linked to the radical right¹⁰—announced his intention to run in the EP elections. By adopting a confrontational stance against the so-called “deep state” and presenting himself as a defender of truth amid alleged misinformation from traditional media, he framed his campaign as a crusade against corruption and political decay. Just a few months later, the party made a surprise breakthrough, obtaining 4.5% of the vote (800,763 votes) and securing three Members of the European Parliament (MEPs). Its vote share was almost half that of VOX (9.6% and 6 seats), and it surpassed Podemos (3.3%), falling slightly short of Sumar (4.6%)¹¹.

Characterising SALF poses challenges, particularly regarding its ideological core, due to the absence of a formal electoral programme. Nonetheless, we consider SALF part of the radical right, akin to VOX (Marcos-Marne et al., 2021; Ramos-González and Ortiz, 2021), since its main ideological tendencies align with defining features of this party family (Mudde, 2007; 2019). Given its highly personalistic leadership, we rely primarily on Alvisé’s public statements and social media content to describe SALF’s profile.

Substantively, SALF combines a strongly nativist agenda with punitive “law-and-order” cues and a pronounced anti-partitocratic stance. On immigration, Alvisé has repeatedly advocated mass deportations and welfare exclusion for immigrants¹², presenting these measures as responses to insecurity and multiculturalism (Belver, 2024). He has also endorsed highly punitive approaches to crime and public order, often referencing figures such as Nayib Bukele (Belver, 2024; Alcutén, 2024). At the same time, SALF’s rhetoric is explicitly anti-system.¹³ It portrays political parties as inherently corrupt, denounces partitocracy, and frames representative institutions as a source of long-standing decay (Lucas, 2024; EFE, 2024).¹⁴ These positions go beyond standard anti-elitism and reflect an anti-politics orientation.

Finally, SALF’s international positioning provides additional contextual cues. Two of its three MEPs have become independent members of the European

10. He has often collaborated with alternative digital media linked to the radical right in Spain (Colmena de Datos, 2024).

11. Electoral support for VOX and SALF at the municipal level can be seen in Appendix B, Figure B.1 and Figure B.2, respectively.

12. Tweet posted in X by @Alvisé_oficial_ on 08/09/2024 at 1:48 pm available at: https://x.com/Alvisé_oficial_/status/1832747872816603542

13. Tweet posted in X by @Alvisé_oficial_ on 14/12/2024 at 1:41 pm available at: https://x.com/Alvisé_oficial_/status/1867912701445636559

14. Tweet posted in X by @Alvisé_oficial_ on 05/09/2024 at 8:37 am available at: https://x.com/Alvisé_oficial_/status/1831582464310935561

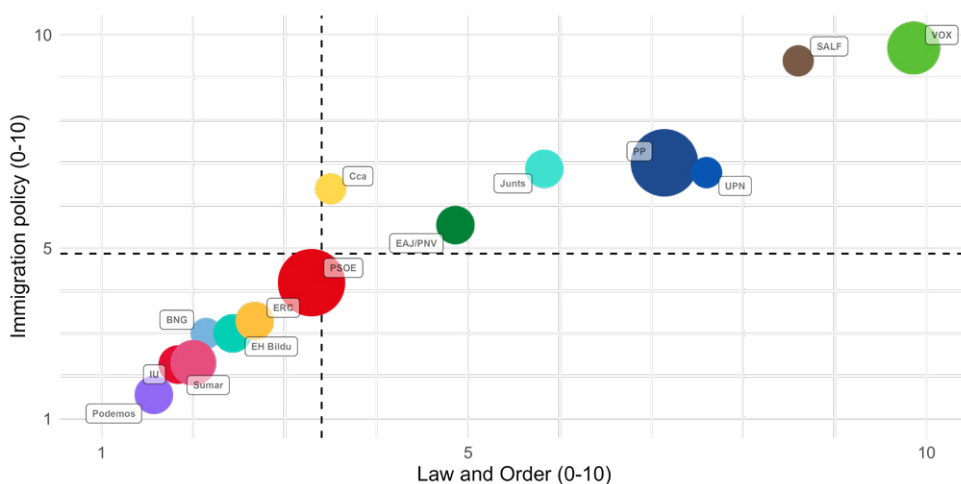
Conservatives and Reformists (ECR) parliamentary group (VOX's former European family) while Alvisé has been excluded from it due to allegations of illegal campaign financing (Viaña, 2024). Taken together, SALF can be understood as a challenger radical right actor mobilising political discontent through a highly personalistic and anti-partitocratic style, rather than as a conventional party organisation with a fully programmatic platform (Padilla Moreno-Torres et al., 2025).

4.2. *The electoral competition between SALF and VOX*

Given that both actors belong to the radical right family, one might expect their narratives to be broadly aligned. Indeed, they are ideologically proximate and draw support from overlapping electoral pools: almost half of SALF voters previously supported VOX (42.9%), while only 22.8% came from the PP, the mainstream conservative force (see Figure B.4 in Appendix B). Nonetheless, consistent with the incumbent-challenger distinction discussed in Section 2, salient contrasts emerge in how each actor frames politics and communicates with voters. While VOX incorporates elements of anti-elitism, SALF goes further by rejecting the legitimacy of political parties altogether.

FIGURE 1.

PARTY POSITIONS ON IMMIGRATION AND AUTHORITARIANISM



Source: Developed with CHES data.

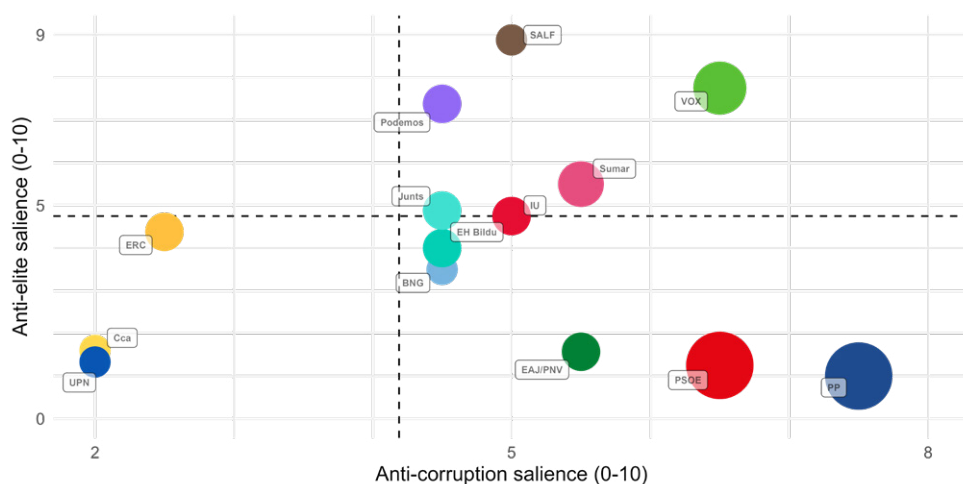
To situate the parameters of this competition on the supply side, we summarise the main similarities and contrasts across the four key dimensions identified in our theoretical framework. First, both parties emphasise nativist themes, though SALF's rhetoric is more uncompromising, particularly regarding welfare exclusion and

deportation proposals.¹⁵ Despite these nuances, CHES assigns both parties similar positions on immigration (see Figure 1).

Second, CHES indicates that law-and-order narratives are more pronounced for VOX than for SALF (see Figure 1), although SALF also deploys punitive cues (especially in relation to immigrant offending) and publicly admires authoritarian leaders such as Bukele (Viejo, 2024). These positions align with the definition of authoritarianism as “the belief in a strictly ordered society, in which infringements of authority are to be punished severely” (Mudde, 2007: 23).

Third, the clearest difference concerns anti-partitocracy. SALF adopts a markedly anti-politics and anti-system stance, whereas anti-partitocratic rhetoric was not central to VOX’s early appeal (Heyne and Manucci, 2021). For instance, Alvise has openly attacked several state institutions and even called for the removal of the Spanish King following his sanction of the Amnesty Law related to the Catalan independence process (Matellano, 2024). This stance is particularly striking given the traditionally strong support for the monarchy among the Spanish right (Hernández et al., 2021). In line with this, CHES portrays SALF as more salient on anti-elite issues than VOX (see Figure 2).

FIGURE 2.
PARTY POSITIONS ON ANTI-ELITE AND ANTI-CORRUPTION



Source: Developed with CHES data.

Finally, their communication environments differ sharply. SALF is closely tied to digital platforms (especially Telegram, YouTube, and TikTok) through which Alvise disseminates simplified and confrontational messages (Padilla Moreno-Torres et al.,

15. Tweet posted on X by @Alvise_oficial_ on 08/09/2024 at 1:48 pm available at: https://x.com/Alvise_oficial_/status/1832747872816603542

2025). By contrast, VOX supporters tend to consume content from ideologically aligned outlets, combining traditional media with emerging digital newspapers (Heyne and Manucci, 2021). Overall, these contrasts capture the supply-side backdrop of an intra-family contest between an institutionalised incumbent and a person-alistic outsider challenger.

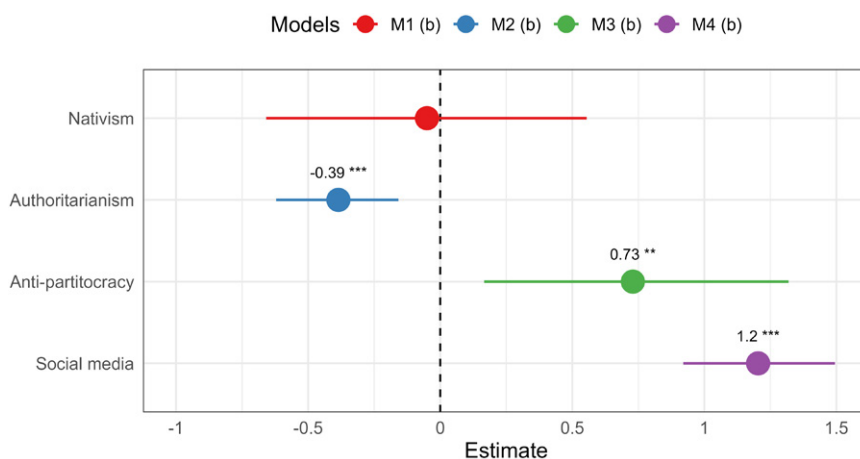
5. EMPIRICAL ANALYSIS

Figure 3 presents the log-odds coefficients of the logit models. As explained above, we estimate four different regression models to examine each hypothesis. We begin by analysing the influence of the ideological core of voters on their decision to support VOX or SALF. The first model (M1) shows a clear absence of effect of the nativist index on support for either formation (p - value > 0.05). In substantive terms, the estimated coefficient indicates that variations in nativist attitudes do not translate into meaningful differences in the probability of voting for SALF rather than VOX. Therefore, we cannot affirm that it determines the choice of one of the two actors.

Nevertheless, it is worth highlighting that these nativist attitudes have a significant and positive effect when comparing SALF with the mainstream centre-right (see Appendix B, Figure B.6 and Table B.3) and with all parties combined (see Table B.2). These findings suggest that SALF mobilises a segment of the electorate with nativist attitudes, consistent with the ideological foundations of the radical right. However, this does not serve as a key distinguishing factor in its direct competition with VOX. Therefore, the results support the first part of the hypothesis (H1), but not the second, as both VOX and SALF appear to draw on electorates with comparable levels of nativist predispositions.

FIGURE 3.

LOG-ODDS COEFFICIENTS FROM BINARY LOGISTIC MODELS PREDICTING VOTE FOR SALF (vs. VOX)



Note: The full models are presented in the Table B.1.

Continuing with the analysis of the ideological core, M2 tests the validity of the authoritarian expectancy. The results reveal a statistically significant negative effect ($p - value < 0.001$) of authoritarian attitudes on support for SALF. In essence, the coefficient indicates that authoritarian predispositions are associated with a lower probability of voting for SALF and, conversely, with a higher probability of supporting VOX.

However, it should be noted that we did not find a statistically significant relationship when comparing SALF with the PP, but did find one in relation to all parties. In other words, authoritarianism distinguishes SALF from the broader party system, but not from the mainstream centre-right. These results suggest that although authoritarianism is notably in SALF's narratives, it does not determine its electoral support. It is VOX who capitalises on this issue (see Figure B.6), consolidating its appeal among voters with stronger preferences for order, authority and hierarchical social arrangements. Thus, the results validate the first part of the assumption (H2), but do not confirm the second part.

Turning now to the idiosyncratic context that has led to SALF's success, our results corroborate both expectation 3 (M3) and 4 (M4). Firstly, we find a positive statistically significant effect ($p - value < 0.01$) of the negative opinions about political parties on the support for SALF. Substantively, higher levels of anti-partitocracy attitudes increase the probability of voting for SALF relative to VOX, confirming our third hypothesis (H3). This result suggests that SALF has managed to succeed as a competitive alternative to VOX in attracting voters with anti-partitocracy attitudes. In this sense, support for SALF appears closely linked to a more systemic critique of representative democracy and to the perception that political participation can be articulated outside traditional party structures.

Moreover, this effect is much more prominent when compared to the mainstream centre-right and to all parties combined. This pattern indicates that SALF's voters not only express dissatisfaction with specific parties, but also question the broader role of political formations as intermediaries in the functioning of democracy and embrace the belief that democracy can function without them.

Secondly, we observe a positive and significant relationship ($p - value < 0.001$) between using social media as a primary source of information and voting for SALF. The coefficient indicates that reliance on digital platforms substantially increases the probability of supporting SALF relative to VOX. In line with our fourth expectation (H4), this finding indicates that SALF has positioned itself as a competitive alternative to VOX in attracting voters who primarily rely on social networks for information, with this effect being even more marked when comparing SALF voters with those who support the PP and other parties. This result aligns with the social context in which SALF emerges as a political actor, placing significant emphasis on a constituency that is particularly engaged through Instagram and Telegram. The latter, in particular, presents the most pronounced gap compared to VOX voters (see Figure B.7). For its part, VOX receives greater support among voters who use social media platforms such as X, Facebook, and TikTok, which in the latter case mitigates the previously noted association between that platform and the figure of Alwise. Overall,

these results suggest that the differentiation between both parties is linked not only to attitudinal factors but also to distinct patterns of media consumption and digital engagement.

Finally, we analyse certain control variables that are particularly relevant. M5 (Figure B.5 and Table B.1) highlights age as a key factor: younger individuals are more likely to support SALF over VOX. Educational and income levels are also significant, as voters with higher levels show a greater preference for supporting SALF. Similarly, employment status plays a role, as individuals with an active job have a higher propensity to support SALF. By contrast, when SALF is compared with all parties or with the PP—and likewise for VOX in relation to this party—the direction of these effects is reversed. In addition, ideological self-placement on the left-right scale is also important. The results indicate that SALF voters position themselves significantly less to the right than VOX voters, although they are still clearly more right-wing compared to the electorate of all parties combined (see Table B.2). This pattern is further corroborated by the multinomial model, where both VOX and SALF voters appear significantly more right-wing than those of the PP, with the estimated coefficient for VOX being notably higher (see Table B.3). These findings reinforce the interpretation of our main results. While both parties compete within the same ideological camp, VOX maintains a closer alignment with the traditional ideological core of the radical right, while SALF's electoral appeal seems more anchored in attitudinal elements such as anti-partisan sentiment and digital media consumption patterns. Moreover, although it is not a distinctive feature between VOX and SALF, the data show that SALF mobilises the male electorate more effectively than the mainstream right and all parties as a whole (see Tables B.2 and B.3), a pattern consistent with established findings in the literature on the radical right. Collectively, these control variables help delineate a socio-demographic profile of SALF voters in comparison with those of VOX, which complements the attitudinal elements identified in the main models.

6. DISCUSSION

The emergence of VOX in 2018 put an end to what was known as Spanish exceptionalism, understood as the country's apparent immunity to the rise of the radical right that had spread throughout other European contexts. Today, not only has that mirage been left behind. Spain is now home to not one but two radical right-wing parties with a national presence. The recent emergence of SALF has reopened the fragmentation of the political space on the right, previously divided between the PP, a weakened Cs, and VOX. However, the most analytically relevant development is not fragmentation itself, but direct competition within the radical right. Despite the ideological proximity between VOX and SALF, both parties appear to mobilise partially differentiated electorates, raising new questions regarding the internal structuring of this political family.

Our findings suggest that this competition is not structured primarily along the canonical ideological pillars of the radical right. Nativist attitudes, although relevant when comparing SALF with the PP and the rest of the party system, do not significantly differentiate between VOX and SALF voters. This finding suggests that nativist stances shape inter-bloc competition, distinguishing the radical right from the rest of the options, but not as an axis of intra-bloc differentiation between ideologically similar formations. Specifically, nativism is a key feature of the radical right, but it does not determine the choice between these two parties (H1).

Similarly, authoritarian attitudes do not favour SALF. Voters with these beliefs show a statistically significant preference for VOX (H2). Far from competing directly for the same electorate, VOX reinforces its appeal among voters with authoritarian predispositions and clear orientations on law and order, consolidating its link with the classic ideological core of the radical right. These results point to an internal differentiation between more ideologically structured narratives (VOX) and more reactive ones, whose intensity does not necessarily translate into support for SALF. On the contrary, the findings suggest that SALF positions itself more as a de-ideologised option, less marked by explicit ideological codes and more focused on channelling specific grievances.

This is precisely the main finding of this study. While VOX's electoral appeal is based mainly on the ideological narratives typical of the radical right, SALF's appeal rests less on this framework and more on its ability to channel discontent towards the political and media elites. On the one hand, the results show that SALF voters not only distrust political parties, but also directly question their role in the functioning of democracy, thus confirming the central role of criticism of 'partitocracy' as a differentiating factor in the competition between the two parties (H3). In this sense, anti-partitocratic attitudes do not only express political discontent. SALF seems to capitalise on a demand for representation—a deep mistrust—which is articulated against parties as legitimate intermediaries between citizens and institutions.

On the other hand, the data confirm our fourth expectation (H4) given that their consumption of information is overwhelmingly channelled through social media, especially platforms such as Telegram, where the party has built its own information community, disconnected from traditional channels. This finding highlights the centrality of the media ecosystem in structuring competition within the radical right. In particular, the preference for alternative digital channels suggests the existence of communication circuits that are relatively autonomous from conventional media, in which narratives of distrust are articulated. SALF seems to have managed to insert itself effectively into these environments, building its own information communities that reinforce the cohesion and mobilisation of its electorate.

These patterns help explain the coexistence of VOX and SALF, and suggest that the fragmentation of the radical right is not always motivated by programmatic differences, but rather by alternative modes of mobilisation and different frameworks of appeal to a similar electoral base. While VOX presents a more ideologically structured

profile, SALF seems to capitalise on a more de-institutionalised electorate oriented towards discontent and resentment. Therefore, the distinguishing factor lies not only in substantive ideological content, but also in the communication strategy and the actors targeted by adversaries through which support is built.

7. CONCLUSIONS

This study set out to analyse the determinants of vote choice between VOX and SALF in a context marked by the recent fragmentation of the radical right. Drawing on CIS data, we examined whether traditional ideological predictors —nativism and authoritarianism— or alternative attitudinal factors better explain intra-bloc competition.

Empirical results reveal that the competition between VOX and SALF is not structured on traditional ideological bases. Nativist attitudes are not decisive in explaining the preference between these two parties. Furthermore, authoritarianism —one of the canonical ideological pillars of the radical right— does not favour SALF either, as voters with these beliefs prefer VOX. Instead, anti-partitocracy and alternative media consumption emerge as the primary differentiating factors. This suggests that SALF's electoral appeal is driven less by ideological radicalism, where VOX is strong, than by its capacity to mobilise disaffection and anti-elite sentiment through alternative communication channels. These findings contribute to the literature on radical right competition by showing that fragmentation within this political family may be shaped by differences in mobilisation strategies and institutional trust, rather than solely by ideological divergence.

However, certain nuances must be considered when interpreting these results. Although SALF has experienced a decline in electoral support since the European elections, currently standing at around 3% of voting intention, this development should not be interpreted as a sign of political failure. In a remarkably short period of time, the party has achieved a stable institutional presence and consolidated an identifiable electoral base, a feat that took VOX several years to accomplish. Furthermore, its appeal among younger voters and its prominent presence on social media suggest significant growth potential. This could intensify as public confidence in traditional institutional channels of representation continues to decline or deteriorate further. In this sense, SALF is positioning itself as a player with real possibilities for expansion in future electoral cycles.

Finally, this case contributes to a broader comparative debate. The Spanish experience aligns with developments observed in other European contexts —such as *Konfederacja* (*Confederation Liberty and Independence*) in Poland, REC in France, *Motoristé sobě* (AUTO, Motorists for Themselves) in the Czech Republic and *Danmarksdemokraterne* (DD, *Denmark Democrats*) in Denmark— where the radical right is evolving from a monolithic bloc into a more internally competitive and plural configuration. Spain therefore offers a valuable case for understanding how intra-family competition reshapes the radical right in contemporary democracies.

Overall, the emergence of SALF should not be interpreted as an isolated anomaly, but as part of a broader transformation affecting the radical right in Europe. In Spain, this transformation reflects three interrelated processes: the growing fragmentation of the right-wing space, the erosion of traditional mechanisms of political representation, and the centrality of digital platforms in structuring political mobilisation. Together, these dynamics help explain the evolving configuration of radical right competition in contemporary democratic systems.

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IMANOL NEGRAL

Department of Political Science and Administration, Euskal Herriko Unibertsitatea/ Universidad del País Vasco

imanol.negral@ehu.eus

<https://orcid.org/0000-0003-3142-399X>

Imanol Negral is a PhD candidate at the University of the Basque Country in the Department of Political Science and Administration, and in the Society, Politics and Culture doctoral programme, focusing on the Radical Right parties in Europe and the voters who support this type of political party. Previously, Imanol completed a Master’s Degree in Political and Electoral Analysis at the Juan March Foundation (UC3M) and a Bachelor’s Degree in Political Science and Public Management at the University of the Basque Country. He has been a visiting researcher at the WZB Berlin Social Science Center. His research interests include radical right political parties, electoral behaviour, public opinion research and quantitative social research.

ÁLVARO SÁNCHEZ-GARCÍA

Department of Political Science, Universidad de Salamanca

Spanish Centre for Political and Constitutional Studies

asanchezgarcia@usal.es

<https://orcid.org/0000-0001-8396-3782>

Álvaro Sánchez-García is a García-Pelayo fellow in the Spanish Centre for Political and Constitutional Studies. He holds a PhD in Comparative Politics from the Area of Political Science and Administration at the University of Salamanca. Previously, Álvaro completed a Master’s Degree in Political and Electoral Analysis at the Juan March Foundation (UC3M) and a Bachelor’s Degree in Political Science and Public Administration at the University of Salamanca. He has been a visiting researcher at the University College Dublin (UCD) School of Politics and International Relations (SPIRe), Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Instituto de Ciências Sociais (ICS) da

Universidade de Lisboa, and Università della Calabria. His research interests include political geography, populist radical parties, economic geography, and rural-urban studies.

APPENDIX

Appendix A. Data information

TABLE A.1.

CIS SURVEYS AND VOX AND SALF SAMPLES

Study	Completion date (in 2024)	N	VOX N (%)	SALF N (%)	Hypothesis
EU Pre-electoral	May 8-17	6,434	460 (7.15)	199 (3.09)	
Special: EU Election Campaign	May 23-30	7,491	516 (6.89)	317 (4.23)	H4
June Barometer	May 31-Jun 6	4,011	307 (7.65)	42 (1.05)	
Special: Social Inequalities and Trends	Jun 6-11	4,006	229 (5.72)	61 (1.52)	
EU Post-electoral	Jun 17-21	3,010	234 (7.77)	119 (3.95)	H4
Special: Happiness and Social Values	Jun 26-28	2,843	174 (6.12)	73 (2.57)	
July Barometer	Jul 1-4	4,007	282 (7.04)	94 (2.35)	
Special: Public Opinion and Tax Policy XLI	Jul 5-11	4,005	230 (5.74)	92 (2.30)	
Special: Tourism and Gastronomy II	Jul 18-26	4,024	199 (4.95)	56 (1.39)	
September Barometer	Sep 2-6	4,027	309 (7.67)	80 (1.99)	
Special: <i>Latinobarómetro</i> XVI	Sep 6-11	2,543	169 (6.65)	66 (2.60)	H1 and H3
Special: Fertility, Family and Childhood	Sep 11-19	5,741	318 (5.54)	116 (2.02)	
Special: Culture and Lifestyles	Sep 20-27	3,701	202 (5.46)	55 (1.49)	
October Barometer	Oct 1-11	4,005	318 (7.94)	62 (1.55)	
Special: Support Networks	Oct 1-11	4,003	315 (7.87)	67 (1.67)	
Special: Polarisation and Ideology	Oct 11-21	3,928	276 (7.03)	91 (2.32)	H2
November Barometer	Nov 2-7	4,009	280 (6.98)	69 (1.72)	
Special: Social Trends IV	Nov 8-14	3,800	245 (6.45)	73 (1.92)	
Special: Welfare State Attitudes II	Nov 20-28	3,857	243 (6.30)	64 (1.66)	

Study	Completion date (in 2024)	N	VOX N (%)	SALF N (%)	Hypothesis
December Barometer	Dec 2-9	4,621	338 (7.31)	84 (1.82)	
Special: Political Participation	Dec 12-18	2,562	180 (7.03)	38 (1.48)	
Total		86,628	5,824 (6.72)	1,918 (2.21)	

TABLE A.2.
DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS OF THE DEPENDENT VARIABLES

Variable	Categories	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
<i>Main dependent variable</i>						
Voting intention on VOX vs. SALF					0	1
	SALF (1)	1,918	—	—		
	M1	66				
	M2	91				
	M3	66				
	M4	436				
	M5	1,918				
	VOX (0)	5,824	—	—		
	M1	169				
	M2	276				
	M3	169				
	M4	750				
	M5	5,824				
<i>Secondary dependent variables</i>						
SALF vs. Other parties					0	1
	SALF (1)	1,918	—	—		
	Other parties (0)	60,345	—	—		
	M1	1,672				
	M2	2,900				
	M3	1,672				
	M4	7,492				
	M5	60,345				
PP vs. VOX and SALF					1	3
	PP (1)	17,400	—	—		
	VOX (2)	5,824	—	—		
	SALF (3)	1,918	—	—		

TABLE A.3.

DESCRIPTIVE STATISTICS FOR THE INDEPENDENT AND CONTROL VARIABLES

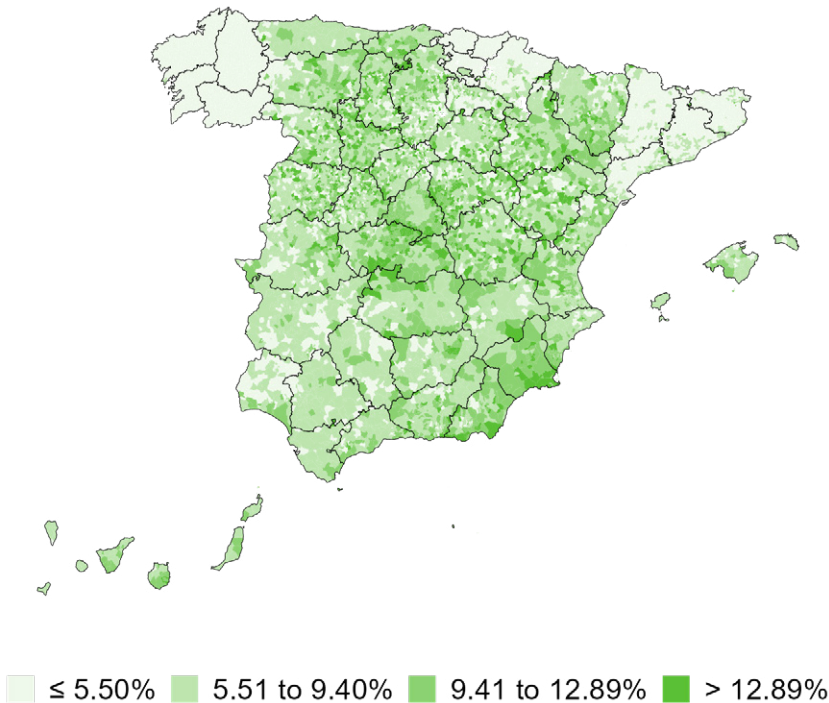
Variable	Categories	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
<i>Independent variables</i>						
Nativism. Immigrants...		2,336	2.12	0.58	1	4
are good for the country's economy	—	2,449	2.05	0.72	1	4
come to compete for our jobs	—	2,501	1.91	0.70	1	4
cause an increase in crime	—	2,445	2.3	0.93	1	4
improve our society with ideas and culture	—	2,466	2.25	0.76	1	4
Authoritarianism		3,860	2.38	1.01	1	5
The state must guarantee security and order	—	3,884	2.80	1.33	1	5
I would not mind living in an undemocratic country	—	3,898	1.97	1.19	1	5
Anti-partitocracy					0	1
	Disagree (0)	1,499	—	—		
	Agree (1)	950	—	—		
Media consumption					0	1
	Other media (0)	6,415	—	—		
	Social media (1)	4,074	—	—		
<i>Control variables</i>						
Sex					0	1
	Female (0)	41,852	—	—		
	Male (1)	44,776	—	—		
Age	—	86,627	50.68	1.63	18	98
Habitat					0	1
	Rural areas (0)	14,360	—	—		
	Urban areas (1)	72,268	—	—		
Education level					0	1
	Low/medium (0)	41,176	—	—		
	High (1)	45,248	—	—		
Employment status					0	1
	Does not work (0)	32,956	—	—		
	Paid work (1)	53,589	—	—		

Variable	Categories	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
Net income					0	1
	Low: ≤ 1,800 euros (0)	21,484	—	—		
	High: ≥ 1,801 euros (1)	61,769	—	—		
LR scale		2,445 / 79,960	4.70 / 4.80	2.43 / 2.42	0* / 1**	10

Note: * For the ‘Special: *Latinobarómetro XVI*’ survey only; ** For the rest of the surveys.

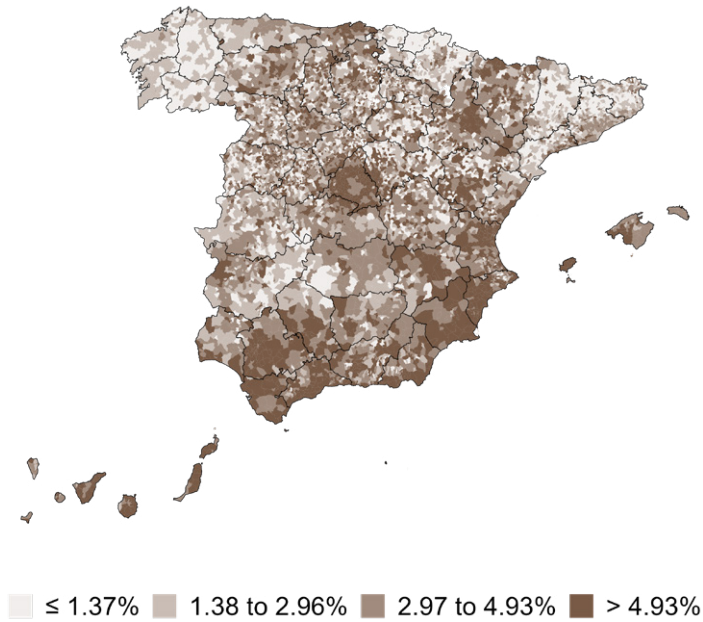
Appendix B. Complementary material

FIGURE B.1.
GEOGRAPHICAL DISTRIBUTION OF VOX VOTE IN THE EP ELECTIONS



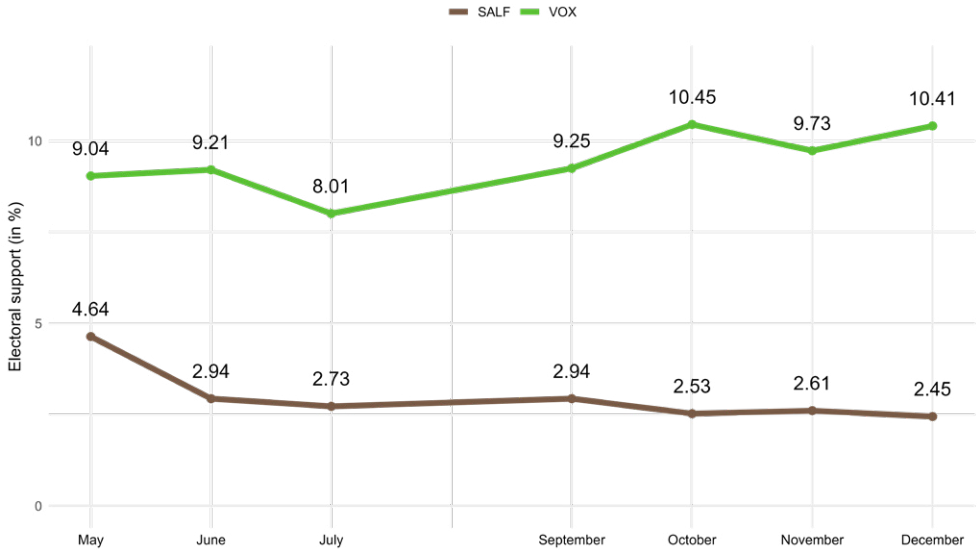
Source: Developed at the municipal-level with the data of Spanish Ministry of Home Affairs.

FIGURE B.2.
GEOGRAPHICAL DISTRIBUTION OF SALF VOTE IN THE EP ELECTIONS



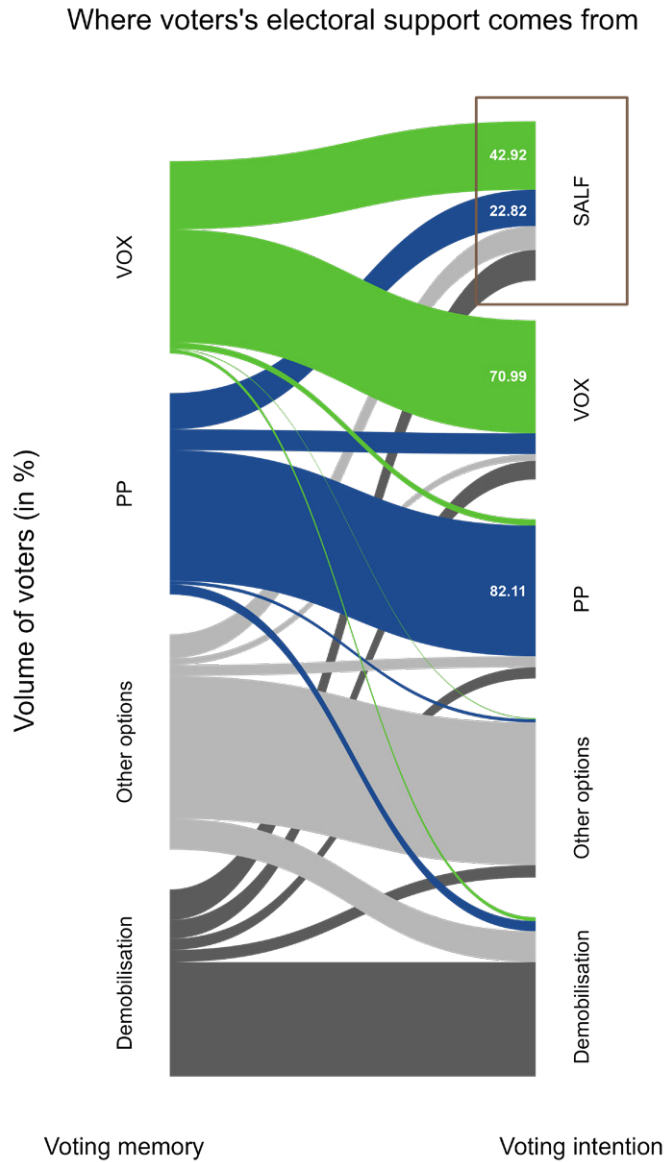
Source: Developed at the municipal-level with the data of Spanish Ministry of Home Affairs.

FIGURE B.3.
EVOLUTION OF VOTING INTENTIONS FOR VOX AND SALF IN CIS SURVEYS



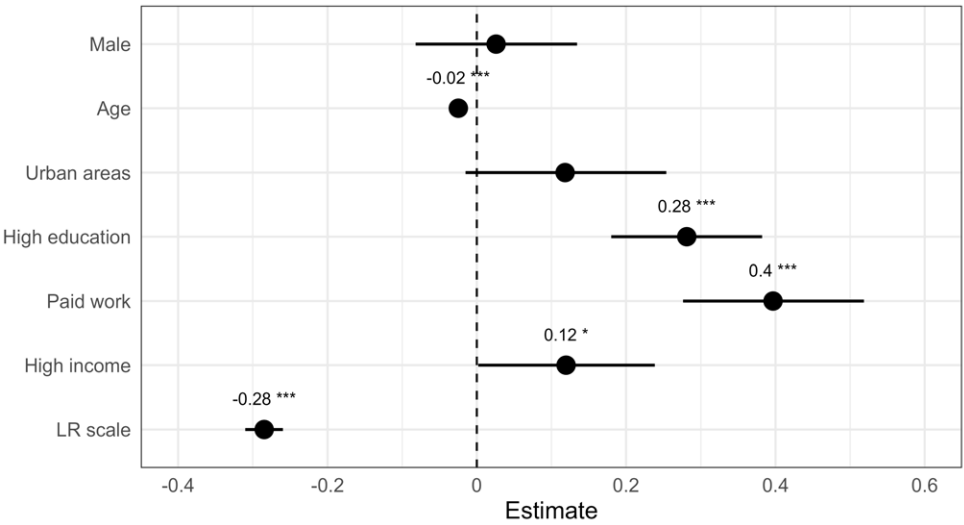
Source: Developed with all CIS questionnaires published from May to December 2024.

FIGURE B.4.
SALF VOTE TRANSFER



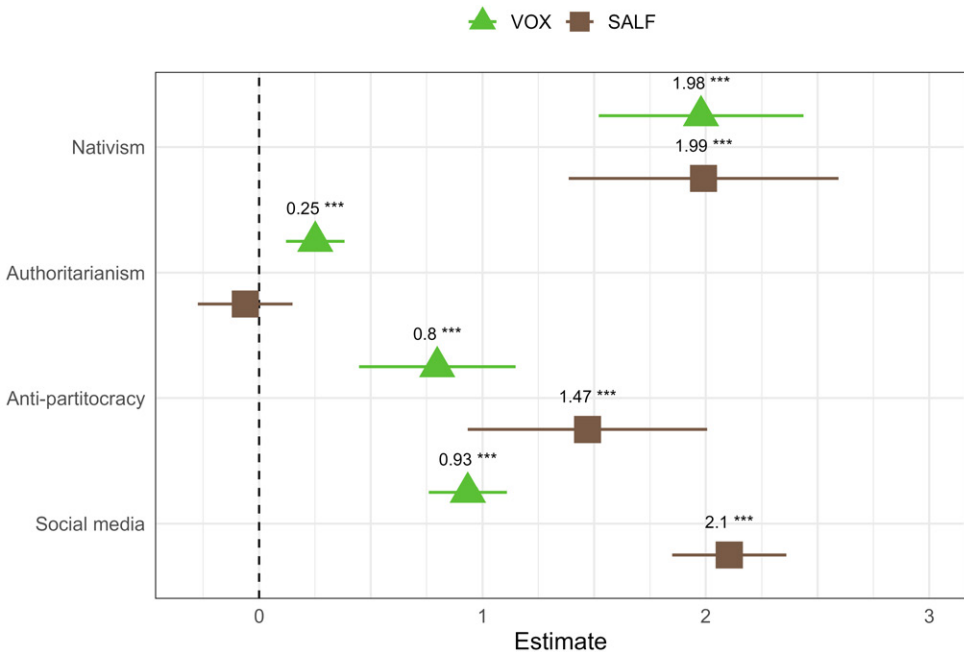
Source: Developed with all CIS questionnaires published from May to December 2024.

FIGURE B.5.
LOGIT MODEL OF THE CONTROL VARIABLES ON SUPPORT FOR VOX vs. SALF



Note: The full model is presented in the Table B.1.

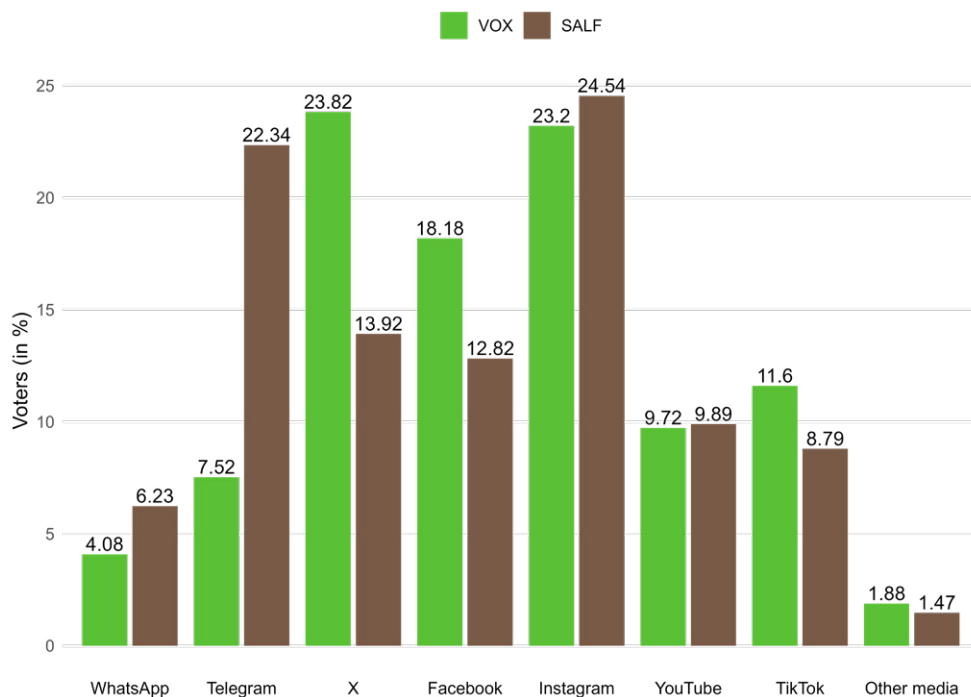
FIGURE B.6.
MULTINOMIAL MODEL ON SUPPORT FOR VOX AND SALF vs. PP



Note: The full models are presented in the Table B.3.

FIGURE B.7.

DISTRIBUTION OF MEDIA USED FOR INFORMATION AMONG VOTERS OF EACH PARTY



Source: Developed with “Special: EU election campaign” and “Post-electoral” surveys.

TABLE B.1.
VOX vs SALF LOGIT MODEL

Variables	M1 (a)	M1 (b)	M2 (a)	M2 (b)	M3 (a)	M3 (b)	M4 (a)	M4 (b)	M5
Sex (<i>ref. female</i>)									
Male		-0.39		-0.02		-0.39		-0.31**	0.03
Age		-0.02*		-0.02**		-0.02**		-0.03***	-0.02***
Habitat (<i>ref. rural areas</i>)									
Urban areas		-0.01		0.78		0.05		0.25	0.12
Education level (<i>ref. low/medium</i>)									
High		0.29		0.50*		0.24		0.41***	0.28***
Employment status (<i>ref. does not work</i>)									
Paid work		0.07		0.61*		-0.17		0.06	0.40***
Net income (<i>ref. low</i>)									
High: < 1,801 euros		0.19		0.11		0.09		0.25	0.12*
LR scale		-0.11		-0.38***		-0.12		-0.32***	-0.28***
Nativism	-0.23	-0.05							
Authoritarianism				-0.37***		-0.39***			
Anti-partitocracy (<i>ref. disagree</i>)									
Agree					0.65**	0.73**			
Media consumption (<i>ref. other media</i>)									
Social media							1.30***	1.20***	
Intercept	-0.24	0.86	-0.07	-2.20**	-1.40***	0.55	-1.52***	1.77***	1.60**
Fixed Effects by survey type	No	No	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Nagelkerke's Pseudo R ²	0.003	0.06	0.04	0.22	0.03	0.09	0.09	0.24	0.16
Observations	215	198	359	324	226	205	1,185	1,090	7,162

Note: the significance levels are *** p < 0.001; ** p < 0.01; * p < 0.05

TABLE B.2.
SALF VS. OTHER PARTIES' LOGIT MODEL

Variables	M1 (a)	M1 (b)	M2 (a)	M2 (b)	M3 (a)	M3 (b)	M4 (a)	M4 (b)	M5
Sex (<i>ref. female</i>)									
Male		-0.16		0.52 ^{**}		-0.01		0.41 ^{***}	0.65 ^{***}
Age		-0.04 ^{***}		-0.04 ^{***}		-0.04 ^{***}		-0.04 ^{***}	-0.04 ^{***}
Habitat (<i>ref. rural areas</i>)									
Urban areas		-0.21		0.86 ^{**}		0.08		0.08	0.11
Education level (<i>ref. low/medium</i>)									
High		-0.05		-0.31		-0.13		0.04	-0.15 ^{***}
Employment status (<i>ref. does not work</i>)									
Paid work		0.32		0.96 ^{***}		0.16		0.27 ^{***}	0.53 ^{***}
Net income (<i>ref. low</i>)									
High: < 1,801 euros		-0.07		-0.04		-0.32		0.16	-0.14 ^{**}
LR scale		0.23 ^{***}		0.29 ^{***}		-0.38 ^{***}		0.29 ^{***}	0.31 ^{***}
Nativism	1.94 ^{***}	1.59 ^{***}							
Authoritarianism			0.26 ^{**}	-0.05					
Anti-partitocracy (<i>ref. disagree</i>)									
Agree					1.64 ^{***}	1.18 ^{***}			
Media consumption (<i>ref. other media</i>)									
Social media							2.25 ^{***}	1.69 ^{***}	
Intercept	-7.97 ^{***}	-6.47 ^{***}	-4.13 ^{***}	-4.93 ^{***}	-4.14 ^{***}	-4.17 ^{***}	-4.39 ^{***}	-4.73 ^{***}	-3.72 ^{***}
Fixed Effects by survey type	No	No	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Nagelkerke's Pseudo R ²	0.18	0.27	0.01	0.14	0.08	0.22	0.13	0.24	0.17
Observations	1,638	1,574	2,952	2,814	1,685	1,608	7,919	7,536	59,317

Note: the significance levels are *** p < 0.001; ** p < 0.01; * p < 0.05

TABLE B.3.
VOX AND SALF vs. PP (AS REFERENCE CATEGORY) MULTINOMIAL MODEL

Variables	M1 (b) VOX	M1 (b) SALF	M2 (b) VOX	M2 (b) SALF	M3 (b) VOX	M3 (b) SALF	M4 (b) VOX	M4 (b) SALF	M5 (b) VOX	M5 (b) SALF
Sex (<i>ref. female</i>)										
Male	0.42*	0.03	0.75***	0.63**	0.48**	0.12	0.77***	0.44***	0.73***	0.73***
Age	-0.04***	-0.06***	-0.03***	-0.05***	-0.04***	-0.06***	-0.02***	-0.05***	-0.04***	-0.06***
Habitat (<i>ref. rural areas</i>)										
Urban areas	-0.30	-0.40	0.13	0.82*	-0.13	-0.05	-0.06	0.10	0.01	0.09
Education level (<i>ref. low/medium</i>)										
High	-0.61**	-0.33	-0.76***	-0.61**	-0.58***	-0.36	-0.39***	-0.10	-0.45***	-0.33***
Employment status (<i>ref. does not work</i>)										
Paid work	0.26	0.32	0.28	0.95***	0.20	-0.02	0.06	0.12	-0.04	0.39***
Net income (<i>ref. low</i>)										
High: < 1,801 euros	-0.27	-0.12	-0.15	-0.19	-0.39	-0.35	-0.14	-0.02	-0.35***	-0.33***
LR scale	0.25***	0.12	0.40***	-0.02	0.33***	0.19**	0.33***	-0.03	0.39***	0.04***
Nativism	1.98***	1.99***								
Authoritarianism			0.25***	-0.06						
Anti-partitocracy (<i>ref. disagree</i>)					0.80***	1.47***				
Agree										
Media consumption (<i>ref. other media</i>)										
Social media							0.93***	2.10***		
Intercept	-5.70***	-4.80***	-3.66***	-1.15	-1.58**	-0.98	-3.12***	-1.14***	-2.21***	-0.09
Fixed Effects by survey type	No	No	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Nagelkerke's Pseudo R2	0.36		0.25		0.28		0.29		0.23	
Observations	1, 812	1, 812	3, 480	3, 480	1, 926	1, 926	9,948	9,948	71,085	71,085

Note: the significance levels are *** p < 0.001; ** p < 0.01; * p < 0.05

Appendix C. Supplementary references

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